BALAJI SANKARAN

IBM i (iSeries / AS/400) Architect | Administration | Transitions & Transformations | Cloud Migration | Presales
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IBM i Architect with 17+ years across system administration, transitions and transformations, cloud migration, presales and client coordination. Designs and delivers Power Systems solutions for Pharma, Healthcare, Insurance, Retail and Engineering clients, with growing focus on AI-assisted operations and monitoring.

CORE SKILLS

Platforms: IBM i / OS400 (V5R3–V7R6), VIOS 4.x, HMC V10, Power 5 → Power 10, Linux partitions
Tools: BRMS + ICC, FalconStor VTL, Halcyon, Robot HA, MIMIX, Ansible AWX, Nagios Core, Skytap on Azure, IBM Cloud
Practice: OS & firmware upgrades, PTF management, DR planning and execution, backup/recovery, DASD & user access management, ServiceNow / Remedy

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Consultant | HCL America Inc. *Dec 2018 – Present*

- Lead cloud migration engagements end to end — assessment of existing IBM i Power infrastructure, risk identification, remediation, and successful on-prem to Skytap on Azure migration.
- Build and configure IBM i servers; perform OS upgrades (V7R2→V7R3, V7R3→V7R4, V7R4→V7R5), scratch installs of V7R6, HMC V10R3 and VIOS 4.1.0.21, firmware upgrades and PTF management.
- Implemented BRMS + ICC backup for both cloud and on-prem partitions; own backup, recovery and disaster recovery design, including full DR builds (HMC partition creation, LIC/OS restore, SAN and network configuration).
- Delivered proofs of concept for Ansible AWX automation and Nagios Core monitoring; currently researching practical AI applications in IBM i environments to improve operational efficiency and modernization.
- Run knowledge transitions for new customers — questionnaires, end-to-end run books and steady-state handovers and manage client relationships plus hardware/software contract renewals.

Technical Specialist | HCL Technologies Ltd. *Jul 2009 – Nov 2018*

- Led a 7-member IBM i team for a pharma client, owning client coordination, cross-platform dependencies and end-to-end operations.
- Owned quarterly maintenance, DR testing, hardware maintenance and internal/external audits across production IBM i partitions.
- Managed BRMS backups (control groups, media policies), profile and authority management, printer and ASP administration, disk additions and performance tuning.

FEATURED PROJECT — iMONITOR

Enterprise IBM i monitoring dashboard designed and built end to end. Single pane of glass for all IBM i, combining live health metrics with an AI assistant for operational questions.

- Stack: Streamlit front end with Plotly visualisations, Agno agents on a local Ollama (llama3.1:8b) model with Mapepire for IBM i data access.
- Deployed on a RHEL server behind nginx over HTTPS, serving the IBM i Center of Excellence team.
- Surfaces system health, subsystem and job status, disk and storage trends, and natural-language querying of environment data — reducing manual green-screen login and checks.

SELECTED DELIVERIES

- Hardware migration from Power 8 to Power 10, and end-to-end cloud migration from on-premises to Skytap on Azure.
- Implemented FalconStor VTL from scratch as a cloud-hosted backup solution, covering the complete end-to-end setup: FalconStor installation and configuration, integration with IBM i, and the creation and configuration of backup policies, control groups, backup schedules, and recovery procedures.
- Scratch installs of IBM i V7R6, HMC V10R3 and VIOS 4.1.0.21; partition builds for multiple OS flavors (IBM i and Linux) and versions.
- BRMS + ICC backup implementation on cloud, and full DR execution — LIC from media, OS from tape, SAN storage assignment and network configuration.
- Capacity and performance diagnostics using Navigator for i, Performance Data Investigator, Collection Services and SQL services over QSYS2.

PUBLICATIONS

- **IBM i Near-Zero Downtime Migration with MWA** — HCLTech white paper, March 2026. Contributing author and presenter; describes how phased migration and background synchronization enable near-zero downtime transitions for IBM i workloads.

EDUCATION

B.Tech, Information Technology — Anna University, Chennai, India | 2004 – 2008